AFRICAN DIASPORA
TRADE & INVESTMENT SUMMIT
Building Bridges. Delivering Prosperity.

Institutional SME Recruitment and Country Partnership Pack

Issued by	**Pan-African Chamber of Commerce (PACC)**
Implementation partner	**Entrust Africa**
Location	**Addis Ababa, Ethiopia**
Date	**January 2027 (exact dates to be confirmed)**
SME participation	**107 SMEs: 20 from each of five regions, plus 7 added places**
Registration deadline	**15 December 2026**
Registration	**https://adtis.entrust-africa.com/**

DOCUMENT 1

Official Institutional Invitation

Subject: Invitation to Partner in Mobilising SMEs for the African Diaspora Trade and Investment Summit 2027

Dear [Title and Name],

The Pan-African Chamber of Commerce (PACC) is pleased to invite [Institution Name] to participate as an Institutional Country Recruitment Partner for the African Diaspora Trade and Investment Summit (ADTIS), scheduled for January 2027 in Addis Ababa, Ethiopia.

ADTIS is being organised to strengthen commercial relationships between African businesses, international buyers, investors and the African diaspora. The summit will bring together selected African SMEs, 30 to 50 buyers from around the world, business leaders, institutional representatives, procurement organisations, importers, distributors and investment partners.

Our objective is to facilitate practical business connections that can lead to trade agreements, distribution relationships, investment partnerships and access to new markets.

We are targeting 107 selected SMEs: 20 from each of the EAC, SADC, ECOWAS, IGAD and North Africa regions, plus seven Central African country places. We are now engaging national institutions to help identify and mobilise businesses with credible products, production capacity, export potential and investment opportunities.

We would welcome [Institution Name] as a Country Recruitment Partner, supporting the identification and nomination of qualified SMEs from [Country].

We invite your institution to:

1. Identify and nominate suitable SMEs from your country.
2. Circulate the official ADTIS registration link through your business networks, ahead of the 15 December 2026 registration deadline.
3. Help identify priority sectors and commercially competitive products.
4. Appoint a focal person to coordinate with the ADTIS organising team.
5. Support the participation of your country's business delegation, including by sponsoring selected SMEs or helping to secure sponsors in your country to cover their travel, lodging and exhibition space.

PACC, working with Entrust Africa as its platform and implementation partner, will coordinate SME registration, assessment, selection and participation management.

We believe your institution's involvement will help ensure that your country's participation is commercially relevant and representative of businesses with genuine opportunities for international engagement.

We would appreciate an opportunity to discuss this partnership and agree on a practical country mobilisation plan.

For further information, please contact thomas@panafricanchamber.com or info@entrustafrica.com. SME registration: https://adtis.entrust-africa.com/

Yours sincerely,

Office of the Chairman
Pan-African Chamber of Commerce (PACC)

DOCUMENT 2

ADTIS Summit Overview

Connecting African Businesses with Global Markets, Buyers and Investment

About ADTIS

The African Diaspora Trade and Investment Summit (ADTIS) is a continental trade and investment initiative designed to connect African SMEs with international buyers, investors, distributors, procurement organisations and diaspora business networks.

The summit will take place in Addis Ababa, Ethiopia, in January 2027.

ADTIS seeks to move beyond general business networking by creating opportunities for participating companies to present commercial offerings, engage prospective buyers, explore investment opportunities and establish relationships that can continue after the event.

Why ADTIS?

Many African SMEs have commercially viable products but face difficulties identifying international buyers, accessing distribution networks, meeting export requirements and attracting suitable investment.

At the same time, international buyers and investors often face challenges identifying credible African suppliers and understanding the commercial opportunities available across different markets.

ADTIS is intended to bring these two groups together through a structured platform for business engagement.

Summit objectives

- Connect qualified African SMEs with international buyers and distributors.
- Facilitate cross-border trade and commercial partnerships.
- Showcase African products and production capabilities.
- Connect investment-ready businesses with potential investors.
- Strengthen African diaspora participation in trade and investment.
- Encourage partnerships between African businesses and international business institutions.
- Support practical business relationships beyond the summit.

Expected participation

The summit is targeting:

- 107 selected SMEs: 20 from each of EAC, SADC, ECOWAS, IGAD and North Africa, plus one added place for each of seven Central African countries.
- 30 to 50 buyers from around the world, including importers and distributors.
- Investors and investment organisations.
- African diaspora business networks.
- Chambers of commerce and trade associations.
- Government and institutional representatives.
- Development finance and trade-support organisations.

Priority sectors

The summit will consider commercially viable businesses across sectors including:

- Agriculture and agro-processing.
- Textiles, garments and apparel.
- Manufacturing and industrial products.

- Leather and leather products.
- Gemstones, jewellery and related products.
- Consumer goods and packaged products.
- Construction materials and related industries.
- Technology-enabled products and services.
- Other sectors with credible trade or investment opportunities.

What participating SMEs can gain

- Exposure to prospective international buyers.
- Opportunities to present products and commercial capabilities.
- Business-to-business engagement.
- Potential distribution and procurement relationships.
- Investment and strategic partnership discussions.
- Access to diaspora business networks.
- Visibility within a continental trade and investment platform.

> Participation does not guarantee a purchase order, investment or commercial agreement. The objective is to create structured opportunities for meaningful engagement.

DOCUMENT 3

SME Recruitment Brief

Which businesses should be nominated?

ADTIS is seeking established businesses with products, services or investment opportunities that can be presented to international commercial partners.

Institutions are encouraged to nominate SMEs that demonstrate:

1. Established business operations
Businesses should have a verifiable operating presence and appropriate business registration or legal documentation.

2. Commercial products or services
Companies should have clearly defined products or services, with an identifiable market and commercial proposition.

3. Production or service delivery capacity
Businesses should demonstrate the ability to fulfil orders or scale their operations to meet additional demand.

4. Trade potential
Companies should have existing export activity, experience supplying larger markets, or a credible plan to enter regional and international markets.

5. Financial and operational readiness
Businesses should be able to provide basic business information, state their key financial figures, and show evidence of operational capability. Financial records do not need to be submitted.

6. Investment potential
Businesses seeking investment should be able to explain their funding requirements, intended use of funds and growth opportunities.

7. Commitment to participate
Nominated companies should be willing to complete the assessment process, provide supporting documentation and participate in scheduled summit activities.

Priority business profiles

We particularly encourage nominations of:

- Manufacturers with identifiable production capacity.
- Exporters seeking additional international buyers.
- SMEs with products suitable for regional or international distribution.
- Women-owned and youth-led businesses with credible commercial operations.
- Businesses with scalable products and clear growth opportunities.
- Companies seeking strategic investors or distribution partners.

Registration

All nominated businesses must complete the official registration and assessment process by **15 December 2026**. Registration portal: https://adtis.entrust-africa.com/

Twenty SMEs will be selected from each of EAC, SADC, ECOWAS, IGAD and North Africa, with one added place for each of seven Central African countries. Each selected SME will need to be sponsored by a sponsor or institution in its own country, covering travel, lodging and exhibition space (indicative cost in Document 5).

Institutional nomination does not automatically guarantee selection. All businesses will be subject to the same eligibility and assessment process.

DOCUMENT 4

SME Eligibility and Selection Framework

Assessment and selection process

ADTIS will use a structured assessment process to identify the 107 participating SMEs: 20 from each of five regions, the East African Community (EAC), the Southern African Development Community (SADC), the Economic Community of West African States (ECOWAS), the Intergovernmental Authority on Development (IGAD) and North Africa, plus one added place for each of seven Central African countries.

The assessment is intended to establish the commercial credibility, readiness and potential of each applicant. Entrust Africa will act as the selection committee, using its TRADE methodology. Details of the methodology can be provided on request.

Allocation of places

Region	Places	Added country places (+1 each)	Total
EAC	20	None	20
SADC	20	Republic of Congo, Gabon	22
ECOWAS	20	Cameroon, Equatorial Guinea, São Tomé and Príncipe	23
IGAD	20	Central African Republic	21
North Africa	20	Chad	21
Total	100	7	**107**

Assessment areas

Assessment area	What will be evaluated
Business legitimacy	Registration, ownership and operating history
Commercial offering	Products, services, pricing and market proposition
Trade readiness	Export experience, target markets and trade capability
Financial readiness	Stated financial figures, financial management and funding position
Operational readiness	Production capacity, supply capability and order fulfilment
Investment readiness	Investment requirements and growth potential, where applicable
Diaspora and summit readiness	Partnership potential, buyer relevance and ability to participate

Selection principles

1. All applicants must complete the official registration process by 15 December 2026.
2. Applications will be assessed using consistent criteria.
3. Supporting documents may be requested for verification.

4. Assessment scores will inform selection decisions.
5. Twenty SMEs will be selected from each region, plus the added country places shown above, and country representation and sector diversity will be considered. A country belonging to more than one of these regions will be counted under one only.
6. Investment readiness will be evaluated in a way that does not unfairly disadvantage companies that are not seeking investment.
7. Final selection will be made by Entrust Africa as the selection committee, using the TRADE methodology.
8. Each selected SME will need to be sponsored by a sponsor or institution in its own country, covering travel, lodging and exhibition space.

Selection stages

Stage	What happens
1. Registration	SMEs submit their company and commercial information by 15 December 2026.
2. Eligibility screening	The organising team checks basic eligibility and required information.
3. Assessment	Eligible SMEs complete the structured readiness assessment.
4. Evaluation	Applications are reviewed and ranked against the assessment criteria.
5. Final selection	Entrust Africa, as the selection committee, confirms participating SMEs for each region and added country place, taking account of country and sector representation.
6. Participation confirmation	Selected SMEs receive formal notification and instructions for sponsorship and summit preparation.

DOCUMENT 5

Country Recruitment Partner Framework

Institutional partnership role

PACC invites selected institutions to support ADTIS as Country Recruitment Partners.

The role is to help identify commercially relevant SMEs and coordinate national participation.

Expected responsibilities

A Country Recruitment Partner will be encouraged to:

1. Identify suitable businesses within its membership or national business network.
2. Share the official ADTIS registration link before the 15 December 2026 deadline.
3. Nominate companies that meet the recruitment profile.
4. Encourage nominated businesses to complete registration.
5. Identify priority sectors and commercially competitive products.
6. Appoint an institutional focal person.
7. Support communication with participating SMEs.
8. Sponsor selected SMEs from its country, covering their travel, lodging and exhibition space, or help secure sponsors or institutions in its country to do so.
9. Where possible, facilitate introductions to buyers, investors and relevant business networks.

What PACC and ADTIS will provide

PACC and the ADTIS organising team will:

- Provide official recruitment and communication materials.
- Provide access to the SME registration portal.
- Coordinate registration and assessment.
- Communicate selection outcomes.
- Provide country-level recruitment progress updates.
- Recognise participating institutional partners.
- Facilitate opportunities for institutional engagement during the summit.
- Coordinate buyer and investment engagement opportunities, including with the 30 to 50 buyers attending from around the world.

Partnership recognition

Subject to agreement, participating institutions may be recognised as:

- Official ADTIS Country Recruitment Partner.
- Institutional Country Partner.
- Strategic Trade and Investment Partner.

Recognition will reflect the institution’s agreed role and actual contribution.

Indicative sponsorship cost per SME

Sponsors cover travel, lodging and exhibition space. The figures below are indicative, based on one delegate and four nights. Actual costs will depend on the final summit dates and the country of departure.

Item	Indicative cost (USD)
Return airfare	500 to 1,200
Hotel, four nights	400 to 800 (100 to 200 per night)
Exhibition space	About 1,000
Total per SME	**About 1,900 to 3,000**

Visas, meals, local transport and the shipping of product samples are not included in this estimate.

Partnership activation

The proposed activation process is:

Step	Action
Step 1	Institution confirms interest and nominates a focal person.
Step 2	PACC and the institution agree on a country mobilisation plan.
Step 3	Institution circulates the recruitment materials and registration link.
Step 4	SMEs register and complete assessments by 15 December 2026.
Step 5	The ADTIS team shares recruitment progress and coordinates next steps.

A formal memorandum of understanding may be considered for institutions seeking a broader or longer-term relationship. It is not a prerequisite for beginning SME mobilisation.

DOCUMENT 6

SME Registration and Nomination Instructions

Official registration portal: https://adtis.entrust-africa.com/
Registration deadline: 15 December 2026

For institutions

Institutions should:

1. Identify SMEs that fit the ADTIS recruitment profile.
2. Share the official registration link with nominated businesses.
3. Encourage companies to complete all required registration fields.
4. Ask companies to upload the requested supporting documents.
5. Maintain a record of the businesses they have nominated.
6. Notify the ADTIS team of their nominated companies and focal person.

For SMEs

Companies should:

1. Open the official registration portal.
2. Complete the company registration form.
3. Provide accurate business and contact information.
4. Describe their products and services.
5. Provide production and commercial information.
6. Complete the assessment questions.
7. Upload supporting documents where requested.
8. Submit the application and retain their reference details.

Important information

- Applications must be completed by 15 December 2026.
- Registration does not automatically guarantee participation.
- All applications are subject to eligibility screening and assessment.
- Only selected SMEs will receive confirmation of summit participation.
- Each selected SME will need to be sponsored by a sponsor or institution in its own country, covering travel, lodging and exhibition space, at an indicative cost of about US$1,900 to US$3,000 per SME (see Document 5).
- Applicants must provide accurate and verifiable information.
- Financial information is given as figures stated by the company. Financial records do not need to be submitted.

Institutional coordination

Institutions interested in becoming Country Recruitment Partners should contact:

Organisation	Role	Email
Pan-African Chamber of Commerce (PACC)	ADTIS Organising Team	thomas@panafricanchamber.com
Entrust Africa	Implementation and SME platform partner	info@entrustafrica.com

Closing message

ADTIS seeks to build practical commercial connections between African businesses and international markets.

The participation of national institutions will be important in identifying credible businesses, strengthening country representation and ensuring that the summit brings together companies with genuine trade and investment potential.

We invite your institution to work with PACC and its implementation partner, Entrust Africa, to make your country's participation meaningful and commercially productive.

Pan-African Chamber of Commerce
African Diaspora Trade and Investment Summit 2027
Addis Ababa, Ethiopia | January 2027